

D773

Technology and Ethics: Emerging Trends and Society

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A city with 800,000 residents weighs installing traffic cameras that are expected to prevent about 40 serious crashes a year, while recording every passing driver. The vendor is based overseas. A council member argues the total reduction in harm outweighs the privacy cost to drivers. Which framework is she using?

- A. Deontology
- B. Ethical egoism
- C. Utilitarianism
- D. Virtue ethics

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under strict utilitarianism, which fact would most change whether a data-sharing program is right?

- A. The program breaks a promise made to users, though the net effect is unchanged.
- B. New evidence that the program harms far more people than it helps.
- C. The program is legal.
- D. The CEO is known to be dishonest.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A social app with a popular dance-challenge feature could raise ad revenue by 12% by secretly scanning users' private messages for product mentions. An engineer objects that reading private messages without permission is wrong even if users never find out. Which framework best fits her objection?

- A. Deontology
- B. Utilitarianism
- C. Ethical relativism
- D. It is only wrong if the 12% gain is too small.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A deontologist and a utilitarian both oppose a deceptive ad. What is the key difference in their reasons?

- A.** The deontologist asks what a good person would do.
- B.** The deontologist looks at outcomes; the utilitarian looks at duties.
- C.** The deontologist says deception is wrong in itself; the utilitarian says it causes more harm than good.
- D.** There is no difference; both are rule-based.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A startup founder whose company just moved into a larger office asks, “If we want to be known as honest and fair, would we hide these fees in fine print?” Which framework is she using?

- A.** Utilitarianism
- B.** Legal compliance
- C.** Deontology
- D.** Virtue ethics

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which question would a virtue ethicist most likely ask about deploying facial recognition in schools?

- A.** “Is there a universal duty being violated?”
- B.** “What would a caring, just school community do here?”
- C.** “Is it allowed by current law?”
- D.** “Will total safety gains exceed total privacy losses?”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A data broker with 300 employees sells location histories showing visits to clinics and places of worship. No law in its state forbids it, and its revenue doubled last year. The CEO says, "It's legal, so it's ethical." What is the flaw?

- A. It becomes unethical only because revenue doubled.
- B. There is no flaw; law defines ethics.
- C. Anything that earns money is unethical.
- D. Law sets a minimum and often lags technology; a legal act can still be unethical.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A new law requires an app to hand over all users' messages to authorities on request, with no court review. The company refuses and accepts fines. How is this best described?

- A. An act that is illegal but that many would argue is ethical.
- B. Legal but unethical.
- C. Ethical only if the fines are small.
- D. Clearly unethical, because it breaks the law.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A fitness tracker, sold in 40 countries in six colors, asks users to accept a 9,000-word policy. Buried inside, it allows sale of heart-rate data to insurers. Did users give meaningful informed consent to that use?

- A. No, but only because the policy was over 5,000 words.
- B. Yes; clicking "accept" is always informed consent.
- C. Yes, because the policy was available in 40 countries.
- D. No; the use was not clearly explained and there was no real choice to opt out of it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A lender's AI, built by a respected team from a top university, approves loans for similar incomes at 70% for one neighborhood and 40% for another. It was trained on 20 years of past lending decisions. What is the most likely ethical problem?

- A.** The model learned historical bias from past lending data and is scaling it.
- B.** The team's credentials prove the model is fair.
- C.** The 30-point gap is fine because it is under 50 points.
- D.** There is no problem; computers are objective.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A video platform with a new logo tunes its feed to maximize watch time. Teens who watch one diet video soon see mostly extreme diet content. What best explains this?

- A.** It is a privacy violation.
- B.** Optimizing for engagement amplifies attention-grabbing content and narrows what users see.
- C.** The feed is a neutral mirror of what teens want.
- D.** Teens always seek out harmful content.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A national tax agency moves all filing online to save \$30 million a year. Rural residents with poor broadband and older adults without devices struggle to file. The new site won a design award. What is the core ethical issue?

- A.** Algorithmic bias in the tax code.
- B.** The \$30 million in savings justifies any hardship.
- C.** The digital divide: a digital-only service shifts burden onto people without access or skills.
- D.** The site's award shows it is accessible to all.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A city with 800,000 residents weighs installing traffic cameras that are expected to prevent about 40 serious crashes a year, while recording every passing driver. ~~The vendor is based overseas.~~ A council member argues the total reduction in harm outweighs the privacy cost to drivers. Which framework is she using?

Target word: name the framework **Decides:** Weighing total harm and benefit.

A	Confusion set	Would ask whether recording people violates a duty, whatever the totals.
B	Adjacent category	Focuses on the self-interest of the actor, not total good.
C	Correct	Judges the policy by its net consequences for everyone.
D	Confusion set	Would ask what a good city or leader would do, not tally outcomes.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Under strict utilitarianism, which fact would most change whether a data-sharing program is right?

Target word: what matters to utilitarianism **Decides:** Consequences.

A	Confusion set	A duty concern; a strict utilitarian looks only at net outcomes.
B	Correct	Consequences are the only test for utilitarianism.
C	Inverted operation	Legality does not settle net consequences.
D	Adjacent category	A character concern, central to virtue ethics.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A social app ~~with a popular dance challenge feature~~ could raise ad revenue by 12% by secretly scanning users' private messages for product mentions. An engineer objects that reading private messages without permission is wrong even if users never find out. Which framework best fits her objection?

Target word: name the framework **Decides:** Wrong regardless of outcome; treating users merely as means.

A	Correct	A duty-based objection that holds regardless of consequences.
B	Confusion set	Would weigh the 12% gain against harms, not reject it on principle.
C	Adjacent category	Would defer to what a culture accepts, not a universal duty.
D	Wrong stem number	Makes the stem number decide a duty question.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A deontologist and a utilitarian both oppose a deceptive ad. What is the key difference in their reasons?

Target word: contrast reasoning **Decides:** Duty vs. consequences.

A	Confusion set	That is virtue ethics.
B	Inverted operation	Swaps the two frameworks.
C	Correct	Same answer, different grounds.
D	Absolute language	Only deontology is rule/duty-based.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A startup founder ~~whose company just moved into a larger office~~ asks, "If we want to be known as honest and fair, would we hide these fees in fine print?" Which framework is she using?

Target word: name the framework **Decides:** Focus on character: honest and fair.

A	Confusion set	Would tally outcomes of hiding fees.
B	Adjacent category	Law is not an ethical framework, and fine print may be legal.
C	Confusion set	Would cite a duty, not the kind of company to be.
D	Correct	Asks what an honest, fair character would do.

6. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Which question would a virtue ethicist most likely ask about deploying facial recognition in schools?

Target word: reverse: framework to question **Decides:** Character-centered question.

A	Confusion set	A deontological question.
B	Correct	Centers character and the virtues.
C	Adjacent category	A legal question, not virtue ethics.
D	Confusion set	A utilitarian question.

7. Answer D Concept 4

A data broker ~~with 300 employees~~ sells location histories showing visits to clinics and places of worship. No law in its state forbids it, ~~and its revenue doubled last year~~. The CEO says, "It's legal, so it's ethical." What is the flaw?

Target word: legal vs. ethical **Decides:** Legality is a floor, not proof of ethics.

A	Camouflage	Profit growth does not decide the ethics.
B	Inverted operation	Equates the two.
C	Absolute language	Overgeneralizes.
D	Correct	Ethics asks more than law.

8. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A new law requires an app to hand over all users' messages to authorities on request, with no court review. The company refuses and accepts fines. How is this best described?

Target word: the reverse case: illegal but defensible **Decides:** Law and ethics can diverge in both directions.

A	Correct	Shows law and ethics can come apart in either direction.
B	Confusion set	Reverses which side the act falls on.
C	Camouflage	Fine size does not decide the ethics.
D	Inverted operation	Treats law as the definition of ethics.

9. Answer D Concept 5

A fitness tracker, sold in 40 countries in six colors, asks users to accept a 9,000-word policy. Buried inside, it allows sale of heart-rate data to insurers. Did users give meaningful informed consent to that use?

Target word: test of informed consent **Decides:** Users did not clearly understand or have a real choice.

A	Wrong stem number	No word count decides consent; clarity and choice do.
B	Absolute language	A click is not understanding.
C	Camouflage	Reach does not make consent informed.
D	Correct	Consent requires understanding and a real choice.

10. Answer A Concept 6

A lender's AI, built by a respected team from a top university, approves loans for similar incomes at 70% for one neighborhood and 40% for another. It was trained on 20 years of past lending decisions. What is the most likely ethical problem?

Target word: source of unfair outcomes **Decides:** Historical decisions carry past bias into the model.

A	Correct	Biased history in, biased decisions out.
B	Camouflage	Credentials do not test fairness.
C	Wrong stem number	No such threshold makes a disparity ethical.
D	Inverted operation	Algorithms reflect their data.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A video platform with a new logo tunes its feed to maximize watch time. Teens who watch one diet video soon see mostly extreme diet content. What best explains this?

Target word: effect of engagement optimization **Decides:** Engagement goals amplify charged content and narrow exposure.

A	Adjacent category	A related concern, but the mechanism here is amplification.
B	Correct	The objective shapes the feed, not a neutral reflection.
C	Inverted operation	Ignores the design goal driving recommendations.
D	Absolute language	Blames users and overgeneralizes.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A national tax agency moves all filing online to save \$30 million a year. Rural residents with poor broadband and older adults without devices struggle to file. The new site won a design award. What is the core ethical issue?

Target word: name the issue **Decides:** Unequal access to technology.

A	Confusion set	No algorithm is making biased decisions here.
B	Absolute language	Ignores who bears the costs.
C	Correct	Unequal access makes benefits and harms uneven.
D	Camouflage	Design awards do not fix access gaps.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	0	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Utilitarianism judges by consequences	An action is right if it produces the greatest overall good (benefit minus harm) for everyone affected.	Thinking utilitarianism is about the decision maker's own benefit, or about following rules.	Weighing totals of benefit and harm across many people.
2	Deontology judges by duty	Some actions are required or forbidden regardless of outcome; people must be treated as ends, never merely as means.	Assuming a good outcome justifies breaking a duty such as honesty or consent.	"Even if it helps more people, is it right to...?"
3	Virtue ethics judges by character	The right action is what a person of good character (honest, fair, courageous, compassionate) would do; ethics is about who you become.	Treating virtue ethics as a rulebook or as a cost-benefit tally.	"What kind of person/company do we want to be?"
4	Legal is not the same as ethical	Law sets a minimum and lags technology; an act can be legal but unethical, or illegal yet widely seen as ethical.	"It's legal, so it's fine."	A practice defended because no law forbids it.
5	Informed consent and privacy	Meaningful consent requires people to understand what data is collected, how it is used, and to have a real choice.	Treating a long terms-of-service click as full informed consent.	Data used for a purpose users were not clearly told about.
6	Algorithmic bias and fairness	Automated systems can encode and scale human and historical bias through their data and design, so fairness must be tested, not assumed.	Believing computers are objective because they lack feelings.	Unequal error rates or outcomes across groups.
7	Engagement algorithms and the self	Feeds optimized for engagement tend to amplify emotionally charged content and narrow exposure (filter bubbles), shaping identity and beliefs.	Thinking a personalized feed is a neutral mirror of the user's interests.	A platform goal of time-on-site or clicks.
8	Digital divide and global justice	Unequal access to technology, connectivity, and skills means the benefits and harms of technology fall unevenly across people and nations.	Assuming a digital-only service is equally available to everyone.	A service that moves online while some users lack access.

Course scope (public description): Technology and Ethics: Emerging Trends and Society explores the intersection of ethical thinking and technological innovations. A foundational introduction to ethical frameworks is applied to emerging trends in technology, including artificial intelligence, social media, and other forms of digital media. This course examines the impact of technology on our understanding of self, as well as the individual's role in interacting with others in a globalized society. The course helps students gain the ability to recognize ethical actions within the context of current and newly evolving technological landscapes. This course has no prerequisites.